AGENTIC AI ZERO TO HERO · #2 · CHEAT SHEET

# Generative AI vs AI Agents vs Agentic AI

youtube.com/@PavanElthepu
github.com/pelthepu/agentic-ai-zero-to-hero

## PROMPT-DRIVEN
### Generative AI = Writer

**DOES**
Creates content from your prompt, then stops

**TRIP**
"Here's a 5-day plan for Tokyo, Mount Fuji and Kyoto"

**CODE**
"Write a function to validate an email" → a code snippet

**EXAMPLES**
Text, image, video and music models

## TASK-DRIVEN
### AI Agent = Skilled worker

**DOES**
Uses tools to finish one defined task

**TRIP**
"Find and book a Tokyo hotel under $150 a night"

**CODE**
"Implement and test email validation" → writes, runs tests, fixes

**FLOW**
Task → Tools → Action → Done

## GOAL-DRIVEN
### Agentic AI = Project manager

**DOES**
Owns the goal: plans, coordinates many tasks, adapts until done

**TRIP**
"Plan and manage my Japan trip" → flights, hotels, plan, weather, changes

**CODE**
"Deliver a reliable email-validation feature" → plan, build, test, deploy

**FLOW**
Goal → Plan → Act → Observe → Adapt → repeat

| CAPABILITY | GENAI | AI AGENT | AGENTIC AI |
|---|---|---|---|
| Answers questions | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Creates content | ✓ | ~ | ~ |
| Uses tools | ~ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Executes tasks | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Plans | ✗ | ~ | ✓ |
| Coordinates tasks | ✗ | ~ | ✓ |
| Adapts | ✗ | ~ | ✓ |
| **Owns the goal** | ✗ | ✗ | ✓ |

~ = partly, depends on how it's built

### THE ONE-QUESTION TEST

Does it **plan, decide and adapt** toward a goal with little human input?
Yes: Agentic AI. No: it isn't.

### SAME LLM, DIFFERENT SYSTEM

| | |
|---|---|
| LLM + prompt | **Generative AI** |
| LLM + tools + fixed steps | **AI Agent** |
| LLM + tools + memory + planning + loop | **Agentic AI** |

### FOR DEVELOPERS

Anthropic (Dec 2024): a **workflow** runs LLMs and tools on code paths you wrote. An **agent** lets the LLM choose its own steps and tools. LLM + a fixed workflow is not Agentic AI.

Next: How Agentic AI Works, and your first agent in Python